

Grant Opportunities for Lantern OS (Normie Report for Shelby)

Date: May 30, 2026

Reading Time: 4 minutes

Difficulty: Anyone can understand this

Action Required: Yes — specific follow-ups below

THE BIG PICTURE

We found **real grant money** that could fund Lantern OS. Some deadlines are soon. None of them require giving away ownership of the company. This report lists what we found, why each one fits, and exactly what to do next.

THE 4 GRANT OPPORTUNITIES

1. Survival and Flourishing Fund (SFF) — Human Self-Enhancement Round

What it is: A philanthropy run by Jaan Tallinn (cofounded Skype). They give away \$20–40 million per year to projects that help humans thrive alongside AI.

Why Lantern fits:

- They have a theme round called "Human Self-Enhancement and Empowerment" (HSEE)
- It funds tools that help humans stay capable and empowered as AI advances
- Lantern OS is literally a local-first tool that keeps humans organized and in control of their own files and workflows

Money: \$2–4 million total in this round. Individual grants vary.

Deadline: July 8, 2026 at 11:59 PM PT

Type: You can apply as a charity or for-profit. Funding can be non-dilutive (they don't take equity).

Real talk: This is the best fit we found. The description basically reads like Lantern's mission statement.

2. Survival and Flourishing Fund (SFF) — Main Round

What it is: The same fund's general grant round. Three tracks:

- **Main Track:** Broad long-term survival and flourishing of sentient life
- **Freedom Track:** Individual freedom and autonomy
- **Fairness Track:** Fair distribution of benefits and risks

Why Lantern fits:

- Local-first = user owns their data = freedom track fit
- Safety hooks and evidence boundaries = survival track fit
- Open source tooling for regular people = fairness track fit

Money: \$14–28 million total across all three tracks.

Deadline: Rolling application open now.

Type: Same as above — charity or for-profit, non-dilutive possible.

Real talk: Apply here too even if you apply to the HSEE round. They run independently.

3. Mozilla Open Source Support (MOSS) — Foundational Technology

What it is: Mozilla (the nonprofit behind Firefox) gives money to open source projects that make the internet healthier.

Why Lantern fits:

- Lantern OS is open source

- It keeps data local instead of feeding the cloud-everything model
- It empowers users to control their own information

Money: \$10,000 to \$250,000 per award.

Deadline: Rolling / no fixed deadline, but apply sooner for faster review.

Catch: You need a "Mozilla champion" — someone who works at or is connected to Mozilla who will vouch for the project.

Real talk: Smaller money than SFF, but easier process and no equity strings.

4. NSF SBIR / America's Seed Fund

What it is: The U.S. government gives up to ~\$305,000 to small businesses doing deep tech R&D. No equity taken.

Why Lantern fits:

- AI + local-first computing qualifies as deep tech
- They specifically have AI topics open

Money: Phase I = up to ~\$305,000. Phase II = up to ~\$2 million.

Deadline: New solicitations opened June 2, 2026. Project pitches accepted now.

Catch:

- Must be a U.S. small business
- At least 50% owned by U.S. citizens or permanent residents
- Requires a "Project Pitch" first — a short summary they review before inviting a full proposal

Real talk: More paperwork than the others, but it's government money with no strings attached.

QUICK COMPARISON TABLE

Grant	Money	Deadline	Fit for Lantern	Difficulty
SFF HSEE Round	\$2–4M pool	July 8, 2026	Excellent	Medium
SFF Main Round	\$14–28M pool	Rolling	Very Good	Medium
Mozilla MOSS	\$10K–\$250K	Rolling	Good	Easy (if you find a champion)
NSF SBIR	Up to \$305K	Open now	Good	High (government paperwork)

FOLLOW-UP ACTIONS FOR SHELBY

This Week (Before June 6)

1. Pick your top 2

- Recommended: SFF HSEE + SFF Main Round
- Reason: Best fit, most money, real deadline soon

2. Read the SFF HSEE application page

- URL: <https://survivalandflourishing.fund/hsee-application>
- Time needed: 30 minutes
- Goal: Understand what they ask for

3. Draft a one-paragraph project summary

- Use plain language. Example:
> "Lantern OS is a local-first tool that helps regular people organize scattered files, notes, and project material without sending everything to the cloud. It includes safety checks that require human approval before AI takes action. We believe keeping humans in control of their own tools is essential as AI becomes more powerful."
- This paragraph will be reused across all applications.

Next Two Weeks (Before June 20)

- 4. **Apply to SFF HSEE round**
- Step 1: Fill out the Rolling Application
 - Step 2: Fill out the HSEE Supplemental Application
 - Both at: <https://survivalandflourishing.fund/2026/application>
 - Deadline: July 8, 2026

- 5. **Apply to SFF Main Round**
- Same rolling application as above
 - Pick the track that feels most natural (Freedom or Main probably)

- 6. **Find a Mozilla champion (for MOSS)**
- Ask in your network: does anyone know someone at Mozilla?
 - Check LinkedIn for Mozilla employees with connections to local-first, privacy, or open source
 - If no lead in 2 weeks, park this and focus on SFF

This Month (Before June 30)

- 7. **Decide on NSF SBIR**
- If you are a U.S. small business and have bandwidth for government paperwork, draft a Project Pitch
 - If not, skip it. The SFF rounds are better use of time right now.

- 8. **Collect evidence for applications**
- Screenshot the WOW-FACTOR report
 - Link to the GitHub repo
 - List any users, pilots, or demos completed
 - Even one user story is better than zero

WHAT YOU NEED TO HAVE READY

Item	Status	Needed For
One-paragraph project summary	Need to draft	All applications
GitHub repo link	Have it	All applications
Evidence of use (even one person)	Need to document	SFF, MOSS
Financial need statement	Need to draft	All applications
U.S. business status (if doing SBIR)	Check	NSF only

THE BOTTOM LINE

There is real money available that matches what Lantern OS is building.

- The best opportunities:
- **SFF HSEE:** July 8 deadline. \$2–4 million pool. Fits our mission perfectly.
 - **SFF Main:** Rolling. \$14–28 million pool. Also fits well.
 - **Mozilla MOSS:** Smaller but easy. Need a champion.

No revenue claims needed. No investor pitches. Just explain what you built, why it matters, and what you need money for.

CONTACT INFO FOR QUESTIONS

- **SFF:** sff-contact@googlegroups.com
- **Mozilla MOSS:** Apply via <https://mozilla.fluxx.io/apply/MOSS>
- **NSF SBIR:** seedfund@nsf.gov

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Date: May 30, 2026
For: Shelby
Action Deadline: July 8, 2026 for best opportunity

SHELBY'S CHECKLIST (COPY AND TICK OFF)

Done	Action
☐	Read this whole report
☐	Pick top 2 grants to pursue
☐	Draft one-paragraph project summary
☐	Apply to SFF HSEE round (deadline: July 8)
☐	Apply to SFF Main round
☐	Look for Mozilla champion connection
☐	Decide yes/no on NSF SBIR
☐	Document any user/pilot evidence